# PTO and Leave Policy

Document ID: HR-001 | Department: HR | Category: POLICY | Owner: People Operations | Version: 1 | Effective: 2026-01-01

## 1. Paid Time Off Accrual

Full-time employees accrue paid time off (PTO) every month, starting on their first day of employment. Part-time employees working at least 20 hours per week accrue PTO at 50% of the full-time rate.

| Years of service | Accrual per month | Days per year |
|---|---|---|
| Less than 3 years | 1.25 days | 15 days |
| 3 to 5 years | 1.67 days | 20 days |
| More than 5 years | 2.08 days | 25 days |

## 2. Carryover and Cap

Employees may carry over a maximum of 5 unused PTO days into the next calendar year. Any balance above 5 days on December 31 is forfeited, except in California where unused PTO is never forfeited and the accrual instead stops once the balance reaches 1.5 times the annual accrual. PTO is not paid out at termination except where required by state law.

## 3. Requesting PTO

PTO requests must be submitted in Workday at least 2 weeks in advance for absences of 3 or more consecutive days, and at least 2 business days in advance for shorter absences. Managers must approve or reject requests within 3 business days.

## 4. Sick Leave

Sick leave is separate from PTO. Every employee receives 10 paid sick days per calendar year, available from the first day of employment. Sick leave does not carry over. A doctor's note is required only for absences longer than 3 consecutive working days.

## 5. Parental Leave

Birthing and non-birthing parents receive 16 weeks of fully paid parental leave, which may be taken within 12 months of the birth, adoption, or foster placement. Parental leave can be split into at most two blocks. Employees become eligible after 90 days of employment. Contractors and interns are not eligible for paid parental leave.

## 6. Bereavement Leave

Employees receive up to 5 paid days of bereavement leave for the death of an immediate family member (spouse, partner, child, parent, sibling, grandparent, or grandchild) and up to 2 paid days for other relatives.

## 7. Jury Duty and Voting

Helios provides full pay for up to 10 days of jury duty per year, and up to 2 hours of paid time to vote in any public election.